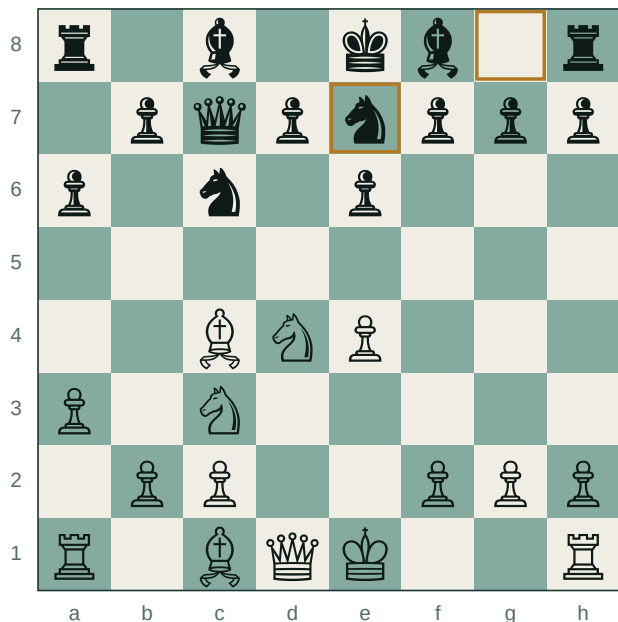


Calculated sacrifices: White, move 8

Calculated sacrifices

White to move



Previous move: 7...Nge7. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

8. Ndb5 axb5 9. Nxb5 Qb8 10. Nd6+

8.Ndb5 The knight moves from d4 to b5. Recorded reply: **8...axb5**.

9.Nxb5 The knight captures the pawn on b5. Recorded reply: **9...Qb8**.

10.Nd6+ Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. From d6 it attacks king on e8 and bishop on c8.

At the end, nominal material is White 35 / Black 37 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by -2. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** -2: the balance goes from +0 to -2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

An attractive attacking picture is not compensation by itself. Continue until the resulting position can be evaluated honestly.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A sacrifice exchanges material for a concrete benefit. The benefit may be mate, a stronger attack, a recovered investment, or lasting activity; it must be shown through moves.

HOW TO LOOK

State what the sacrifice changes: a defender, a line, a king square, or a critical tempo. Calculate acceptance and plausible refusal.

The defending king is on e8. Geometrically undefended: rook on h8 and rook on a8. Check for tactical protection.